

care for the children and the house. If that means Mom goes to the office while Dad stays with baby, so be it.

Husbands: don't be threatened by your wife's earning potential. Embrace it. The money she brings home every month will shore up your financial foundation and strengthen your partnership. Wives: if you want to work, go for it! And if you want to be a working mother, do it! At no previous point in history have so many women enjoyed motherhood *and* successful careers. Strike a balance that's right for you.

FOUR AFFORDABLE PHASE ONE VACATIONS

Phase One Vacations—the trips you go on *before* you have kids—are part of the brick and mortar of a healthy partnership. The memories you make will sustain you over the coming decades. But during the early years, your goal should be to save money, not spend it. Here are four affordable vacation ideas that put a premium on the *time* you spend together, not the money.

1. **Visit a national park.** There's something majestic about being with the person you love in the wilderness. It's a chance to break out of the daily grind, unplug your smart phone and soak up the wonders of nature. Plus, it's cheap. Tent and RV camping can save you thousands on room and board. If you plan your vacation carefully, you can even swing free admission. Every year on Canada Day, entry to national parks, national historic sites and national marine conservation areas is 100 percent free. Bonus: without running water and modern creature comforts, you and your partner can't help but develop a deeper (and potentially smellier) bond.